

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K 10

♣ A 9 8 2



♠ 9 5 3

♥ 9 8 7 2

♦ 8 6 5 3

♣ K 6

♠ K 7 4

♥ A J 10

♦ Q J 4

♣ Q J 10 7

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥9

[showcards N:S4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. North's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, South has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore East must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that East **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since East will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

North has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ K Q 4

♠ K J 5

♥ Q 7 4

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A J 9 5



♠ 7 6 3

♥ K J 10

♦ K J 9 6

♣ 10 7 2

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 8 5

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ 8 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 10

again establish 3 ♣ winners. But South's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣ 9, finessing West for the ♣ 10. This is because ♣ K 10 **or** ♣ Q 10 are twice as likely as ♣ K Q.

[showcards S:C3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠ 10; low cards from North and East, won by South with the ♠ A.

South next plays the ♣ 3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣ K Q.

Play the ♣ 4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣ Q perhaps, dummy's ♣ A will take the trick and South will later play through your ♣ K toward dummy's ♣ J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).

If you play low, he **MIGHT** finesse the ♣ J and

If he does play this way East will win the ♣ 10 and your ♣ K Q will get one more trick.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 6 2
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ K 7 6 3
 ♣ A 9 4 2

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 9 8 5 4 2

♦ -

♣ K J 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 7 3

♥ 10

♦ J 10 9 8 5 2

♣ Q 5

♠ A K 9 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ A Q 4

♣ 10 8 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			

6 ♥ by North

Lead: ♦ J
 have been ♣s, and he has discarded 2 of them.

[showcards W:DJ]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown,
 (wild).

Partner led the ♦ J; ♦ Q from dummy, ♦ K from you
 and ruffed by North.

North then pulls two rounds of trumps, (East discards
 on the second one), followed by his ♠ Q, dummy's
 ♠ A K and dummy's ♦ A. North discards ♣s on the
 last two cards.

The ♣ 6 is then played from dummy and you must
 make a decision - ♣ A or ♣ 2?

Play the ♣ 2.

You have a full count on North's hand. He started
 with 2 ♠s, 7 ♥s, and no ♦s. His other 4 cards must

So he has 2 ♣s left in his hand. If one of them is the ♣ K and you play your ♣ A then you have handed him
 the contract.

By playing low you give him a guess to make. If he plays the ♣ K he will make the contract, but if he plays
 the ♣ J he will go down. He will probably play the ♣ J, figuring you wouldn't have the nerve to duck with the
 ♣ A. He'll know better next time he plays against you.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 4
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ J 9 7 5 4
 ♣ A J 3

♠ 8 6 2

♥ A K Q J 10

♦ 8 3

♣ Q 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 7 3

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ 10 6 2

♣ 8 4

♠ J 9 5

♥ 9 3

♦ A K Q

♣ K 9 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 5			
tricks.			

So the way to beat the contract is to go up with your ♣A, then play ♠K, ♠Q and a third ♠, hoping East holds ♠A x x x.

[showcards S:C9]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♦5; ♦3, ♦10 and won by South with ♦K. South now leads the ♣9 from his hand

Play the ♣A.

First ask yourself "Where are the ♦A and ♦Q?" East doesn't have either one or he would have played it at the first trick. So South has both of them. So with those 3 tricks and the 5 ♥s in dummy South only needs to find one more winner. Assuming he has the ♣K, (or why play the suit), if you play low he will find that one more winner whichever high ♣ he plays.

Next ask yourself "Where is the ♠A?" Clearly East **DOES** have this card; otherwise South has his 9